TONGHUI TIAN

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Department of Economics, Loeb Building B 844, Carleton University

EDUCATION

Carleton University, Ottawa, Canada 2020 to 2026
Ph.D. in Economics
Supervisor: Louis-Philippe Beland

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Illinois, United States 2019
M.S. in Economics (specialized in Econometrics)

Henan University, Henan, China 2017
Bachelor of Economics (major in finance)

PUBLICATIONS

"Gubernatorial partisanship and housing outcomes: evidence from close elections" *with Louis-Philippe Beland*

Public Choice, 2026. Published online 27 August 2026.

Tests whether narrowly elected Republican governors increase housing supply, as pro-growth partisan narratives predict. A close-election regression discontinuity using U.S. county-level permit data from 1980 to 2020 finds no detectable effect on total, single-family, or multi-family permits. The null result is consistent with the median voter theorem, which predicts policy convergence in closely contested elections, and suggests that partisan turnover alone does not overcome localized regulatory and institutional constraints on housing supply.

"AI-assisted teams outperform AI-led teams but not human-only teams in assessing research reproducibility in quantitative social science" *with Abel Brodeur et al.*

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 2026, 123 (22): e2524747123.

Tests whether AI can improve assessments of published quantitative findings without displacing human judgment. The study randomly assigns 103 research teams to human-only, AI-assisted, or AI-led conditions. Human-only and AI-assisted teams perform similarly on most tasks, while AI-led teams perform substantially worse; human-only teams also identify more major coding errors. The results suggest that AI can complement human judgment in reproducibility work but does not yet substitute for human-led teams.

JOB MARKET PAPER

"The Effect of Occupation Level AI Exposure on the Gender Gap in Weekly Labour Input: Evidence from Canada"

Generative AI exposure varies across occupations, but occupation-level averages can conceal whether women and men adjust their labour input differently. This paper links Canadian Labour Force Survey records for prime-age paid employees from 2021 to 2025 to observed AI exposure across 43 occupation groups. A triple-difference design compares women and men within the same occupation and month before and after ChatGPT. Moving from the least- to the most-exposed occupations, the gender gap in usual and actual weekly hours widens by roughly one hour. The usual-hours result is driven by a decline among women. Actual hours fall for both women and men, but more for women, showing that the widening gap is not simply an occupation-wide reduction in hours. Event-study estimates show no pre-period divergence, and the pattern is similar with an alternative exposure measure. The findings provide early evidence that generative AI exposure can widen within-occupation gender differences in labour input and show why average occupational effects do not fully characterize who adjusts.

WORKING PAPERS AND PROJECTS

"The Impact of Gender-Based Pricing Policies on Coverage in Long-Term Care Insurance Markets in the U.S."

Examines whether gender-based pricing changed long-term care insurance participation among single adults, who were directly exposed to the new pricing. A difference-in-differences design using the Health and Retirement Study from 2006 to 2018 compares single and married adults. Coverage among singles fell by about 1.5 percentage points, or 9.3 percent, with the decline concentrated among women. The findings show that more accurate risk classification can reduce participation among people charged more.

"Generative AI boosts productivity across the expertise ladder" *with Abel Brodeur et al.*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Carleton University May 2022 to January 2024

With Louis-Philippe Beland: Built datasets from California judicial, U.S. immigration, and high-frequency traffic records. *For Matthew D. Webb:* Implemented cluster-robust inference tests in R. *For Zhiqi Chen:* Compared FTTP demand, supply, consumer behavior, and competition across developed countries.

Research Assistant, UIUC September to December 2019

For Tatyana Deryugina: Prepared GIS data for a difference-in-differences study of agricultural responses to climate.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant (Carleton University) 2021 to 2025

Responsibilities: Weekly tutorials, project guidance, classroom support, and grading.

Undergraduate Level	
ECON 1001 Introduction to Microeconomics	2021 Summer; 2024 Fall
ECON 1002 Introduction to Macroeconomics	2021 Winter; 2021 Fall; 2022 Fall; 2025 Winter
ECON 2009 Managerial Economics	2024 Fall
ECON 2220 Introductory Econometrics	2025 Summer
ECON 2708 Applied Data Analysis	2022 Fall; 2024 Winter
ECON 3602 International Monetary Problems	2021 Winter
ECON 4020 Advanced Microeconomic Theory	2022 Fall; 2023 Fall
ECON 4052 Corporate Financial Economics	2022 Winter
Graduate Level	
ECON 5020 Microeconomic Theory	2022 Fall; 2023 Fall
ECON 5021 Macroeconomic Theory	2024 Winter

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

W. Irwin Gillespie Graduate Scholarship, Carleton University	2024
Murray Goldblatt Memorial Prize, Carleton University	2023
International Doctoral Scholarship, Carleton University	2020 to 2024
Departmental Scholarship, Carleton University	2020 to 2025
Full-tuition exchange student scholarship, University of Akron, USA	2015 to 2016

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

R; Stata; Python; Mandarin (native); English (fluent)

REFERENCES

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